DRAFT

Household Evacuation Drill Card

Practice moving everyone and essential equipment to a safe ready-to-leave point. This card tests the household plan; it does not replace it.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Exercise only—stop for any real alert or danger. Drills must not imitate an official alert, block a road, create smoke or flames, or require unsafe lifting. Say "DRILL" in every spoken or written drill message. Stop immediately if anyone is distressed, an animal becomes unsafe, equipment could be damaged, or conditions change.

USE THE PLAN YOU ALREADY MADE

Review these handouts before scheduling the drill. Correct the plan there rather than copying it onto this card.

- **EVS-001** — readiness, contacts, meeting places, and final leave-now check
- **EVS-002** — go-bags, medicines, documents, power, and essential equipment
- **EVS-003** — local evacuation terms, decision points, and when to leave
- **EVS-004** — two routes, destinations, and a safe place to pause
- **EVS-005** — primary and backup transportation, pickup, loading, and access
- **EVS-006** — children, caregivers, animals, handlers, and loading practice

Household / location: _____ **Drill date:** _____

Observer / timekeeper: _____ **Planned stop point:** _____

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BEFORE-DRILL CHECKLIST

- ☐ The six EVS handouts above are current, and every participant knows this is a future exercise even though the start time will be unannounced.
- ☐ A responsible organizer chose a calm practice window, checked weather and surroundings, and told neighbors or building staff if the activity might concern them.
- ☐ The organizer selected an unmistakable household-only cue containing the word **"DRILL"**; it does not copy an alert tone, siren, sender name, message format, evacuation order, or emergency-service wording.
- ☐ Every participant may pause or opt out. Children and people who could be distressed know what "DRILL" means; no surprise cue will be used for anyone who needs advance notice.
- ☐ The stop point is on private property or another permitted safe area **before any sidewalk crossing, public road, traffic lane, or vehicle movement into traffic**.
- ☐ Exits and accessible paths are clear. The drill uses no smoke, flame, damaged route, live hazard, road obstruction, unsafe transfer, or lift beyond a person's training and ability.
- ☐ Phones remain available for real calls. The observer will cancel the drill for a real alert, emergency, injury, distress, unsafe animal behavior, or blocked safe exit.

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Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

ASSIGN HOUSEHOLD ROLES

Assign a backup for every essential role. One person may hold more than one role only if the timed practice shows that is workable.

Role	Primary	Backup	Task in this drill
Lead / account for people	_____	_____	Give the drill cue; check names at stop point
Children / dependents	_____	_____	Gather, reassure, and supervise
Animals	_____	_____	Use practiced carrier or restraint
Medicines / medical supplies	_____	_____	Retrieve only the prepared set
Mobility / communication equipment	_____	_____	Bring device, aids, power, and instructions
Go-bags / keys / documents	_____	_____	Move staged essentials without overloading
Transportation assistance	_____	_____	Make the practice request; confirm pickup plan
Observer / timekeeper	_____	_____	Record times and stop unsafe activity

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RUN THE DRILL

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Unannounced simulated alert: At an unannounced time within the agreed practice window, the organizer says or sends: **“DRILL—household evacuation practice. Use our plan now.”** Do not broadcast it publicly or use emergency tones, sirens, agency names, or official-alert styling.

1. **Start and notify.** Timekeeper records the start. The lead gives the household-only cue. Everyone states or demonstrates their assigned action. **Start time:** _____
2. **Gather people.** Caregivers move household members by the practiced accessible path to the planned stop point. Account for everyone; do not search beyond the drill area. **People gathered:** _____
3. **Gather essential equipment.** Assigned people bring only staged go-bags, keys, medicines, communication and mobility aids, and animal equipment identified in EVS-002 and EVS-006. Do not add last-minute packing. **Equipment gathered:** _____
4. **Practice transport contact or loading.** Make only a prearranged practice call or text and begin safe loading in a legal, off-road location. Say “DRILL” to the helper. Do not summon emergency services or an unbriefed provider. **Contact / loading complete:** _____
5. **Stop before public traffic.** Stop at the named safe point before entering or crossing a public road, moving a vehicle into traffic, or beginning the planned route. Account for every person, animal, and essential item. **Ready-to-leave time:** _____

Total time from start to ready-to-leave: _____

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

This is the end of the drill. Do not drive the evacuation route as part of this card. If the household separately practices a route, plan that activity under ordinary traffic laws and the safety limits in EVS-004 and EVS-005.

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

CHOOSE THE VARIANTS YOUR HOUSEHOLD NEEDS

- ☐ **Children:** use simple words and a familiar adult; practice shoes, comfort or communication items, hand-holding, car seats, and the meeting point. Never hide or pretend a caregiver is missing.
- ☐ **Animals:** use the usual handler and species-appropriate carrier, leash, harness, or restraint. Practice calmly and stop for fear, aggression, escape risk, or unsafe lifting. Use EVS-006 for large-animal practice; do not improvise loading.
- ☐ **Mobility devices:** use the normal accessible path and trained assistance. Include device controls, charger or power, transfer aids, and securement notes. Never carry a person or device on stairs or perform a transfer unless the people involved are trained and it is routinely safe.
- ☐ **Medication:** retrieve the prepared, labeled supply or an empty practice container from its normal safe location. Maintain required security and temperature; do not delay or change a dose for the drill.
- ☐ **Transportation assistance:** practice the agreed call or message with a pre-briefed helper, including pickup entrance, passenger count, mobility-device space, animal capacity, and boarding support. Clearly say no actual pickup is requested unless one was scheduled.

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

AFTER-ACTION REVIEW

Talk immediately after the drill. Record observable problems, not blame.

Prompt	What happened?	Change to test next time
Communication failure: who missed or misunderstood the cue or role?	_____	_____
Blocked route: which door, path, gate, or stop point did not work?	_____	_____
Forgotten items: what essential prepared item was missed, and why?	_____	_____
Accessibility barrier: what prevented noticing, understanding, moving, communicating, transferring, loading, or waiting safely?	_____	_____

Obstacles discovered: _____

_____

Corrective actions, owner, and due date: _____

_____

Next practice date: _____ **One change to retest:** _____

REVIEW REQUIRED BEFORE APPROVAL

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

Do not approve this exercise until both reviews are complete.

Accessibility reviewer: _____ **Organization / qualification:** _____

Reviewed routes, cues, roles, timing, assistance, and variants for accessibility barriers.

Required changes: _____ **Date:** _____ **Initials:** _____

Emergency-management or fire-service reviewer: _____ **Agency / role:** _____

Reviewed the simulated alert, stop point, traffic limits, fire safety, and conflict with local procedures.

Required changes: _____ **Date:** _____ **Initials:** _____

Changes completed by: _____ **Date:** _____ **Approval recorded by:** _____

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Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” and “Pets and Animals.” Accessed 2026-09-29. Use EVS-001 through EVS-006 for the household planning guidance this drill tests.